

UNIT-5

MENTAL HEALTH AND WELLNESS

Concept of wellness

Wellness refers to the overall process of maintaining a healthy balance of the mind, body and spirit, which promotes good health and wellbeing. Multidimensional and holistic, wellness is a never-ending process of people becoming aware of and making lifestyle choices in order to enjoy a healthy and fulfilled life.

Definition of Wellness

Wellness is an active process of becoming aware of and making choices toward a healthy and fulfilling life. Wellness is more than being free from illness, it is a dynamic process of change and growth.

"...a state of complete physical, mental, and social well-being, and not merely the absence of disease or infirmity."

- The World Health Organization

"a conscious, self-directed and evolving process of achieving full potential."

- The National Wellness Institute

Eight Dimensions of Wellness

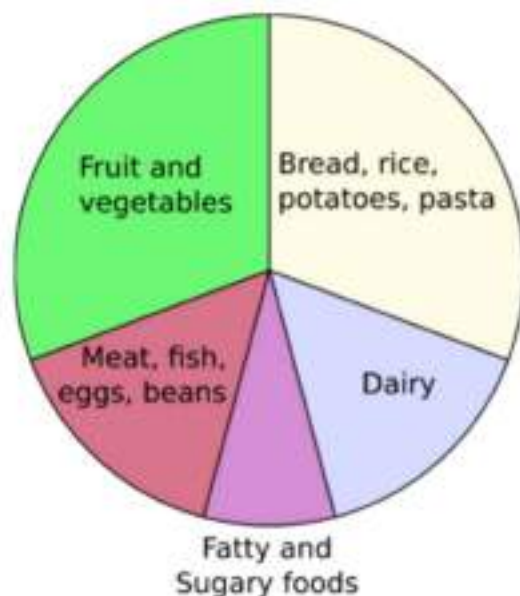
There are eight dimensions of wellness: occupational, emotional, spiritual, environmental, financial, physical, social, and intellectual. Each dimension of wellness is interrelated with another. Each dimension is equally vital in the pursuit of optimum health. One can reach an optimal level of wellness by understanding how to maintain and optimize each of the dimensions of wellness.

1. Emotional Wellness
2. Environmental Wellness
3. Financial Wellness
4. Intellectual Wellness
5. Occupational Wellness
6. Physical Wellness
7. Social Wellness
8. Spiritual Wellness

CONCEPT OF BALANCED DIET

A balanced diet is a diet which contains the quality and proportions of nutrients needed to maintain good health and to sustain life.

A diet is all that we consume in a day. And a balanced diet is a diet that contains an adequate quantity of the nutrients that we require in a day. A balanced diet includes six main nutrients, i.e. Fats, Protein, Carbohydrates, Fibre, Vitamins, and Minerals.



All these nutrients are present in the foods that we eat. Different food items have different proportions of nutrients present in them. The requirements of the nutrients depend on the age, gender, and health of a person.

Importance of a Balanced Diet

The following are the importance of a balanced diet:

- Balanced Diet leads to a good physical and a good mental health.
- It helps in proper growth of the body.
- Also, it increases the capacity to work
- Balanced diet increases the ability to fight or resist diseases.

Components of a balanced diet

Some components of a balanced diet are as follows:

- Fats

Some part of our energy requirement is fulfilled by fats. Fats can be found in fatty foods such as butter, ghee, oil, cheese, etc.

- Proteins

We need proteins for growth purposes and to repair the wear and tear of the body. Protein also helps in building muscle. It is found in dairy products, sprouts, meat, eggs, chicken, etc

- Carbohydrates

We need the energy to process and it is fulfilled by carbohydrates. Carbs provide us energy. Carbohydrates can be found in rice, wheat, chapati, bread, etc. Cereals are our staple food.

- Minerals and Vitamins

Vitamins, Minerals, and Fibre improve the body's resistance to disease. We mainly obtain it from vegetables and fruits. Deficiency diseases like Anemia, Goitre, etc can be caused due to lack of mineral in the body.

ROLE OF ART IN WELLNESS

"The medical profession has come a long way in recognizing the healing benefits of art. My hope is that someday the arts will be considered as significant in everyone's lives as breathing fresh air, eating clean foods, and performing physical exercise." – Renée Phillips

The idea that participating in creative endeavors can be a powerful force for healing has been embraced by many different cultures, religions and societies. Throughout history, people have used drawings, music, dancing, and storytelling as a means to create wellness. Many healing rituals involve chanting and music.

Most people are familiar with the power of the arts to transform lives and alter one's perception of the world. Many of us have had the experience of having a book, movie, or play provide a springboard for future dreams and aspirations. Most of us have experienced what it's like to have a favorite song or painting transport us to a different place and time.

As it turns out, nearly everyone can benefit from participating in the arts. Research has shown that creative expression can lower stress, boost self-esteem and stimulate the mind. A Mayo Clinic study published in *Neurology* showed that people who engaged in the arts – such as painting, drawing and sculpting – in both middle and old age were 73 percent less likely to develop mild cognitive impairment (MCI) than those who didn't engage in artistic endeavors. Those who passively participated in the arts – such as going to the theater, concert or the movies – were 55 percent less likely to develop MCI.

Participating in the arts can also lower stress, which can keep the mind healthier. A study published in *Art Therapy* showed that just 45 minutes of creating art – which included drawing with markers, modeling with clay and/or making collages – lowered the levels of cortisol (a stress hormone) in 75 percent of participants, regardless of their skill level. Just under half of the study participants reported that they had limited experience in making art.

Many health providers are now looking at the arts as of a form of therapy. A recent study from the University at Texas Arlington found that art therapy helped 98 percent of participating veterans better cope with service-related trauma (such as PTSD) or disability. The same percentage of participants reported that art therapy helps them better cope with everyday life.

The creative arts are often used to help those living with dementia. Both passive enjoyment – which may include listening to music or enjoying the beauty of a painting – and active participation in the arts help people living with memory loss to better recall memories and feel more engaged in life.

Music & Memory is a nonprofit organization that creates personalized music programs for older Americans, including those living with dementia. A Brown University study found that senior living communities that adopted the Music & Memory program saw a significant decline in residents using antipsychotic drugs and engaging in disruptive behaviors compared to those communities that didn't adopt the program.

The documentary film "I Remember Better When I Paint" shows how painting can help enrich the lives of those living with Alzheimer's. A study published in the Canadian Journal of Neurological Sciences focused on Mary Hecht, a sculptor who was diagnosed with vascular dementia. She was able to draw detailed sketches and portraits, all from memory, of people she met or of earlier drawings she had created. Artistic abilities, at least in some cases, seem to be preserved in spite of the loss of memory.